



DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

Course Guide

Political Science Analysis

Core course in Political Science, Advanced level

SK2121 (15 credits)

Fall semester 2025

Course Coordinator:

Frida Boräng, frida.borang@pol.gu.se

Course Administrator:

Sandra Grahn, master@pol.gu.se

General information

Learning Outcomes

A student who has passed the course will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- Have in-depth as well as broad knowledge of major Political Science research areas

Competence and skills

- Independently, at an in-depth level, organise, write and present orally short research overviews with topics from various Political Science research areas
- Independently produce text in accordance with good academic practice, including proper citation technique and use of references
- Communicate clearly and proficiently in English both orally and in writing

Judgement and approach

- At an in-depth level understand and critically evaluate Political Science research

Course content

Political Science has developed into a mature academic subject, which has led to further specialization into various sub disciplines or research areas (e.g. Political Behavior, Comparative Politics, Public Administration, Political Theory and International Politics). At the same time there has been increased integration too between the subdisciplines, both theoretically and analytically as well as methodologically. The course aims to give the students an overview of the subject. This aim will be achieved by guiding the students to research classics from the various research areas as well as to current research. The course will apply different analytical perspectives on the various research areas and make the students aware of different research strategies and research methods. Throughout the course, students will gain skills in critically reflected oral and written academic presentation through problem-based research overview assignments.

Course outline

The course is organized around five research areas – Political Theory, Political Behavior, Comparative Politics, Public Administration and International Politics. Each bloc consists of three parts - a “base” lecture, two lectures at the “research front”, and a seminar. The base lecture presents the background and development of the research area, as well as classical theories, concepts and findings. The research front lectures presents the research front and more specifically focus on selected actual research problems, based in current research. For each research area the students are presented seminar assignments in the form of semi-selective subjects or research problems which should be analyzed and discussed in a short seminar paper and discussed at the seminar, using the assigned literature. The examination of the course is based on each of these five papers and the seminars. The seminar assignments are presented in this course guide and further specified in the lectures.

Teachers

Course Coordinator:

Frida Boräng, frida.borang@pol.gu.se

Academic Writing

Jacob Gunderson, jacob.gunderson@gu.se

Research Area: Political Theory

Lina Eriksson, lina.eriksson@gu.se

Research Area: Comparative Politics

Frida Boräng, frida.borang@pol.gu.se

Research Area: Political Behavior

Georgios Xezonakis, georgios.xezonakis@gu.se

Research Area: Public Administration and Administrative Reform

Victor Lapuente Gine, victor.lapuente@pol.gu.se

Research Area: International Politics

Nikolay Marinov nikolay.marinov@gu.se

Information about the schedule:

The schedule and additional information are available at the course's Canvas page. Information about any changes will be posted on Canvas and e-mailed to the participants' GU-addresses. Please check your GU e-mail and the Canvas page regularly during the course.

Seminars and Seminar Papers

For each compulsory seminar, students must submit a seminar paper of 1500–2000 words (excluding the reference list). The word count must be clearly stated in the submission. Please note that the word limits are strict. The paper should be based on the compulsory texts for the research area and the texts assigned for the respective themes. Each Seminar paper + active seminar participation earns 3 credits. Questions or focus for the seminar papers are presented in this course guide and during the lectures by the responsible teacher.

The seminar paper should have the character of a critically reflecting discussion / research overview of the literature in relation to the question or research problems for the respective theme.

At every research seminar, 3-5 students are asked to make an oral presentation of their paper and starting the discussion of the actual theme and research problem. The oral presentation should be approximately between 7 and 10 minutes (please use presentation slides) and should include questions and reflections that could stimulate discussions in the seminar group. It should end by presenting one clearly formulated question to start the following discussion. Each student will make

one presentation during the course. The presentation should be sent to the responsible teacher after the seminar.

After each presentation the students attending the seminar will get 5-10 minutes in groups of 2-3 persons to prepare a comment or reply to the question presented, and thereafter all groups will have the opportunity to present their comments/reflections upon the question.

In order for seminar participants to prepare, the seminar papers should be uploaded on Canvas at 15.00 (the latest) the day before the seminar, and will be found under Documents on Canvas after 15.00.

REMEMBER TO PUT YOUR NAME ON YOUR PAPER AS WELL AS IN THE FILE NAME!

The schedule for the presentations will be uploaded on Canvas. Active participation in the seminars is compulsory.

Criteria for evaluation and grading

The course is examined through five seminar papers, one for each subfield included in the course. In addition to these papers the student must make one oral presentation and actively participate in all five compulsory seminars to pass the course.

The five seminar papers are graded Fail (U), Pass (G), or Pass with Distinction (VG) and awarded 3 credits each. Failed seminar papers have to be completed following the teacher's instruction in order to reach the Pass level.

In order to pass the course (G), the student needs to pass all the assignments. In order to pass the course with distinction (VG), at least 3 of the seminar papers must have the grade VG and the rest of the assignments have the grade G. To obtain the Pass grade the student must fulfill all the learning outcomes. To obtain Pass with distinction the work of the student should show a very good ability to connect theoretical analyses to empirical outcomes, a good, independent analytical ability and that written assignments fulfill high academic standards in term of structure and language.

Completion assignments

Seminar papers: If a student does not upload the paper on time, the completion assignment is to write a short (1000-1500 words) additional paper on one of the other themes for the same seminar.

Seminar participation: if a student does not participate in a compulsory seminar, the completion assignment is to write a short (1000-1500 words) additional paper on one of the other themes for the same seminar.

Seminar paper + seminar participation: if a student neither uploads the paper on time nor participates in the research seminar, the completion assignment is to write an additional paper (1500-2000 words) on one of the other themes for the same seminar.

Oral presentation: In case of undelivered oral presentation the students are required to prepare a power point presentation in print with comments (1000-1500 words).

All completion assignments should be uploaded on Canvas no later than November 27th.

Academic Writing

The three hallmarks of good academic writing are clarity, precision, and intellectual honesty. Unlike some other forms of writing, academic texts should be free from ambiguity, and they should offer the reader plainly stated arguments, not rhetorical tricks. This does not mean that they have to be boring, of course, but it does mean that, whenever there is a conflict between being linguistically elegant and clear, the latter should take precedence. For example, in academic writing, it might be preferable to consistently use the same terms for the same concepts instead of using synonyms, even though this would be dull in other types of writing (such as fiction). To organize the text, a good rule of thumb is to make one point per paragraph.

Good academic writing is cumulative; it proceeds from, communicates with, and seeks to contribute to previous work on the topic of choice. It is essential that the author (or authors) gives due credit to previous work. There should never be any doubt as to whether segments of text, ideas, claims or results are the author's own or drawn from other sources. To ensure this, academic writing requires a transparent system of citation. Never 'copy and paste' text from other sources without citing those sources and enclosing direct quotes in quotation marks. Copying text without indicating it is a quotation constitutes plagiarism. Use references consistently and accurately. These requirements hold for all academic texts, from short student assignments and course papers to master theses and academic books and journal articles. Note that all uploaded texts will be screened for plagiarism.

Further information and relevant links are found on Canvas, and will be further discussed at the lecture on Academic writing.

Help with Academic writing

During the course you have the opportunity to get help with academic writing from Jacob Gunderson. Send your draft paper or questions to Jacob via e-mail (jacob.gunderson@gu.se) and find a date to meet (in-person or zoom). In the personal meetings you can receive feedback and guidance on, for example, your structure, citations, or argumentation style of the text. Note that Jacob cannot give you any feedback on the grading of papers.

Attempts to deceive during examinations

An attempt to deceive during examinations means that a student has attempted to give an impression of their performance in a written exam or some of form of assessment that is not true. That is what is commonly referred to as cheating, or attempting to cheat. There are different kinds of attempts to deceive, such as plagiarism, prohibited aids and prohibited collaboration. Deception can also take other forms.

- **Plagiarism** means that a student has presented someone else's text or other material as if it were their own text or material.
- **Prohibited aid** means that a student has used aids, including AI, that were not permitted according to the instructions.

- **Prohibited collaboration** means that students have collaborated with each other in breach of the instructions.

Plagiarism: Copying material from the Internet, from books, journals, reports, or from a fellow student and then presenting it as one's own is strictly forbidden! Plagiarism is theft of someone else's work and will result in immediate fail of the assignment. Please note that the inclusion of a source in a bibliography list is not in itself sufficient attribution of another's work. In addition, unless it is a proper citation with a reference, any direct copying of text is forbidden. All submitted student work is screened with a program called *Ouriginal*, which compares a student's written work with published materials (including everything published on the internet) and all the work from prior students, to detect plagiarism. The material you have read and based your arguments and factual statements on should always be referenced using proper referencing technique. More information on references and how to avoid plagiarism can be found here:

<https://studentportal.gu.se/english/help-and-guidance/search-read-write/reference-management-and-plagiarism>

Prohibited aid: All your submitted texts should be your own original writing, and not written by someone else or generated by AI. Unless there are specific instructions for the use of AI for an assignment, it should not be used and presented as your own text. The use of any tools to cheat during on campus exams (e.g. DISA) is also strictly forbidden.

Prohibited collaboration: students can discuss their work, but individual submissions must be your own original writing, and hence not too similar the work of others. Be extra careful to avoid using common notes from such collaborations.

Any kind of cheating on examinations is considered a serious offence. Proved or suspected cheating will be reported to the Disciplinary Committee of the University of Gothenburg, in accordance with the procedure of disciplinary matters at the department of political science.

The consequences may be severe for a student if found guilty. A student may be suspended from classes and campus for a determined time-period (from 3 weeks to half a year), which will result in a temporary suspension of all financial aid (including CSN) and may jeopardize a student's residence permit status. More information on disciplinary matters, including plagiarism and its consequences, can be found here: <https://studentportal.gu.se/english/study-environment-and-rules/disciplinary-matters/>

About equal treatment

The University of Gothenburg aims to promote equal rights and opportunities for students and employees and to combat discrimination related to gender, gender identity or gender expressions, ethnicity, religion or other beliefs, sexual orientation, disability or age. If, however, you as a student at the Department of Political Science become subject to such acts and actions, we encourage you to contact us to enable the opportunity for appropriate action. You can contact: the course coordinator, director of studies Birgitta Niklasson, equal treatment representative Ulrika Möller, or student counselor Eva Nilsson. Student counselors have confidentiality. You can also turn to these persons if you experience problems or discomfort in the study environment, even if not targeted at you. All contact information is available on our website.

About the literature

The literature list consists of Goodin, Robert E. (ed.) 2011: *The Oxford Handbook of Political Science*, (available online at the University Library), some articles/ book chapters/books for each research area and some articles for each theme/proposed seminar paper assignment. The detailed literature list for each research area is listed below. If not otherwise stated, all literature is available electronically through the University Library web site. Some literature (marked with *) will be available on Canvas.

Literature and seminar assignments

Course Introduction:

Lindvall, J. (2022). Political science as architecture. *European Political Science* 21, 550–563.
<https://doi.org/10.1057/s41304-022-00388-4>

Mansbridge J. What Is Political Science For? *Perspectives on Politics*. 2014;12(1):8-17.
doi:10.1017/S153759271300368X

Research Area: Political Theory

Basic reading:

Roberts, P. and Sutch, P. (2012). 'Rawls', in *An Introduction to Political Thought – a conceptual toolkit*. Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press, pp x. (pdf available on Canvas)

Swift, A. (2014). 'Nozick and entitlement' and 'Popular opinion: justice as desert', in *Political Philosophy*, 3d edition. Cambridge: Polity Press, pp 31-46. (pdf available on Canvas)

Wolff, J. (2006). 'Property and markets', in *Introduction to Political Philosophy*, 2nd edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press, pp 152-166.

Seminar 1

Theme 1. Luck egalitarianism

One of the main questions engaging philosophers since Rawls famous book A Theory of Justice is the extent to which distributive justice should be sensitive to the choices people have made. Many criticized Rawls for failing to adequately hold people responsible for the consequences of their choices, while at the same time also criticizing him for allowing too much inequality stemming from factors people have no control over, such as their circumstances of their birth, their talents, and their health. These concerns gave rise to a very influential school of thought, called luck egalitarianism. According to luck egalitarianism, people should not receive fewer of society's social primary goods as

a result of factors beyond their control, but they should enjoy or suffer the consequences (good or bad) of their own choices.

Describe the main arguments for luck egalitarianism that you find in Arneson's article below, explain the criticisms raised by Anderson and Scheffler, and Schemmel's arguments for why Anderson, Scheffler and others should still be concerned with distributional equality. Who do you think is right, and why?

Arneson, R. J. (1989). Equality and Equal Opportunity for Welfare. *Philosophical Studies: An International Journal for Philosophy in the Analytic Tradition*, 56(1), 77–93.

<http://www.jstor.org/stable/4320032>

Anderson, E. (1999). What Is the Point of Equality? *Ethics* 109(2): 287–337.

Scheffler, R. S. (2003). What is Egalitarianism? *Philosophy & Public Affairs*, 31: 5–39.

<https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1088-4963.2003.00005.x>

Schemmel, C. (2011). Why Relational Egalitarians Should Care About Distributions. *Social Theory and Practice*, 37(3), 365–390.

Theme 2. Climate justice

Climate change constitutes not only a scientific and social problem, but also a philosophical one: what would justice require in the form of individual, social and political action in a world in which the climate is changing rapidly, threatening life as we know it, as well as the ability of other species to survive. Philosophical insights in climate justice is central to making good decisions about what we should do.

Everybody should read the following:

Caney, S. (2020). Climate Justice. *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*.

Then choose one of the following questions:

1. *Outline the arguments in the papers listed here for and against individual responsibility to change the way we live so as to emit less green house gases. Do you think we each have a responsibility to limit the emissions we as individuals cause? Motivate your answer.*

Hiller, Avram (2011) "Climate Change and Individual Responsibility", *The Monist* 94(3): 349–368

Jamieson, Dale (2010). "When Utilitarians Should be Virtue Theorists". In *Climate Ethics: Essential Readings*, eds. SM Gardiner, S Caney, D Jamieson and H Shue. Oxford: Oxford University Press, pp. 315–331.

Sinnott-Armstrong, Walter (2010). "It's Not My Fault. Global Warming and Individual Climate Obligations". In *Climate Ethics: Essential Readings*, eds. SM Gardiner, S Caney, D Jamieson and H Shue. Oxford: Oxford University Press, pp. 332–346.

Vanderheiden, S. (2016) "Climate Change and Free-Riding". *Journal of Moral Philosophy* 13(1): 1–27.

2. *Mitigating climate change will involve a lot of serious costs to different agents. How should we distribute these burdens between different agents? Explain the views on this question put forward by the following three authors. Do you agree with any of these views? Why/why not?*

Caney, S. (2010) "Climate Change and the Duties of the Advantaged", *Critical Review of Social and Political Philosophy*, 13(1): 203–228

Miller, D. (2008). "Global Justice and Climate Change: How Should Responsibilities be Distributed?" Tanner Lectures on Human Values, 24-25 March, Beijing. Url: http://tannerlectures.utah.edu/_documents/a-to-z/m/Miller_08.pdf

Page, E. (2012) "Give It Up for Climate Change: A Defence of the Beneficiary Pays Principle". International Theory 4: 300-330.

3. *One of the main questions in the literature on climate justice concerns the distribution of emission rights going forward. Who should be allowed to emit how much greenhouse gas? Explain the views put forward by the authors below. Do you agree with any of these views? Why/why not?*

Caney, S. (2009) "Justice and the Distribution of Greenhouse Gases", The Journal of Global Ethics, 5(2), 125-146.

Duus-Otterström, G (2024) "Emissions sufficientarianism", British J of Political Science

Knight, C. (2013). "What is Grandfathering?", Environmental Politics 22(3): 410-427.

Torpman, O. (2020) "Isolationism and the Equal per Capita View", Environmental Politics. Online first.

Theme 3. Human rights

The debate about human rights concerns many questions. One is what grounds human rights as rights: what is it that make humans have rights, and is this purely a feature of the national and international law, or do all humans have rights based some moral, universal principle? Related to this question is another, regarding whether human rights as moral principles are universal, or whether cultural differences mean that these moral principles do not apply to all human beings. Closely related is of course the question of how human rights, fully understood, may come into conflict with cherished liberal principles such as respecting the privacy of family life or with religious practices. Another question is whether there are not only political and civil human rights (such as the right to free speech, or the right not to be tortured), but also economic and social human rights (such as a right to medical care, or a right to housing).

Choose one of the following two questions:

1. *Should we include such things as a right to food, a right to housing, and a right to medical care in our list of human rights? Explain the views put forward in the literature below. Do you agree? Why/why not?*

Ashford, E. (2015). The Alleged Dichotomy Between Positive and Negative Rights and Duties. In C. R. Beitz, and R. E. Goodin (eds), Global Basic Rights (Oxford, Oxford University Press, online edition 2015), <https://doi.org/10.1093/acprof:osobl/9780199604388.003.0005>

Neier, A. (2006). Social and Economic Rights: A Critique. Human Rights Brief 13 (2): 1-3.

Nickel, J. (2019). Human Rights. In Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy.

2. *In all countries, the violations of women's human rights often take place in the family, or as part of cultural honour traditions or religious practices, while at the same time the right to family life, the right to not have one's honour attacked, and the right to practice one's religion are protected by for example article 12 and 18 in the UN Human rights charter. What*

should we do regarding this problem? Explain the views put forward regarding this in the literature below. Do you agree? Why/why not?

- Okin, S.M. (1998). Feminism, human rights, and cultural differences. *Hypatia* 13(2): 32-52.
- Nickel, J. (2019). Human Rights. In *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*.
- Thomas, D. Q., & Beasley, M. E. (1995). Domestic violence as human rights issue. *Albany Law Review*, 58(4), 1119-1148

Research area: Comparative Politics

Basic reading:

- Boix, Carles & Stokes, Susan C. (2009) "Overview of Comparative Politics" in Goodin, Robert E. (ed) *The Oxford Handbook of Political Science*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, pages 543-566.
- Esping-Andersen, G. (1990) *The Three Worlds of Welfare Capitalism*. Polity Press. Chapter 1 (available on Canvas)
- Fearon, James D., and David D. Laitin. "Ethnicity, Insurgency, and Civil War." *American Political Science Review* 97, no. 1 (2003): 75-90.
- Lipset, Seymour Martin. "Some Social Requisites of Democracy: Economic Development and Political Legitimacy." *American Political Science Review* 53, no. 1 (1959): 69-105.
- Mann, Michael. 1984. The Autonomous Power of the State: Its Origins, Mechanisms and Results. *Archives européennes de sociologie* 25(1984): 185-213.
- Tingley, D., & Tomz, M. (2014). Conditional Cooperation and Climate Change. *Comparative Political Studies*, 47(3), 344–368. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0010414013509571>

Seminar 2

Theme 1: States and state capacity

State capacity is a core concept in political science, and state capacity is regarded as a key determinant of economic and political development. Still, there are ongoing debates on how to best conceptualize and measure state capacity. Review the key controversies around definitions and measurement and critically discuss the approaches proposed in the literature.

- Berwich, Elissa, and Fotini Christia. 2018. State Capacity Redux: Integrating Classical and Experimental Contributions to an Enduring Debate" *Annual Review of Political Science*.
- Hanson, Jonathan K. and Rachel Sigman. Leviathan's Latent Dimensions: Measuring State Capacity for Comparative Political Research. *The Journal of Politics* (2021) 83:4, 1495-1510
- Lee, Melissa M. and Nan Zhang (2017). Legibility and the Informational Foundations of State Capacity. *The Journal of Politics* 2017; 79:1, 118-132
- Luna, J. P., & Soifer, H. D. (2017). Capturing Sub-National Variation in State Capacity: A Survey-Based Approach. *American Behavioral Scientist*, 61(8), 887–907. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0002764217720964>
- Soifer, H. State Infrastructural Power: Approaches to Conceptualization and Measurement. *Studies in Comparative International Development* 43, 231–251 (2008). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12116-008-9028-6>

Theme 2: Welfare states and redistribution

The comparative welfare state literature offers various theories explaining why different types of welfare states emerged and were sustained. The empirical focus of this literature has been on welfare state expansion in the Global North during (parts of) the 20th century. 1. Review and critically discuss these theories, paying attention to their building blocks: proposed causal relationships, causal mechanisms, and assumptions. 2. Discuss the relevance of these theories for welfare states outside of the Global North.

- Dorlach, T. The causes of welfare state expansion in democratic middle-income countries: A literature review. *Soc Policy Adm.* 2021; 55: 767–783. <https://doi.org/10.1111/spol.12658>
- Estevez-Abe, Margarita, Torben Iversen, and David Soskice, 'Social Protection and the Formation of Skills: A Reinterpretation of the Welfare State', in Peter A. Hall, and David Soskice (eds), *Varieties of Capitalism: The Institutional Foundations of Comparative Advantage* (Oxford, 2001).
- Holland, A. (2018). Diminished Expectations: Redistributive Preferences in Truncated Welfare States. *World Politics*, 70(4), 555-594. doi:10.1017/S0043887118000096
- Korpi, W. (2006). Power Resources and Employer-Centered Approaches in Explanations of Welfare States and Varieties of Capitalism: Protagonists, Consenters, and Antagonists. *World Politics*, 58(2), 167-206. doi:10.1353/wp.2006.0026
- Swenson, P. (1991). Bringing Capital Back In, or Social Democracy Reconsidered: Employer Power, Cross-Class Alliances, and Centralization of Industrial Relations in Denmark and Sweden. *World Politics*, 43(4), 513-544. doi:10.2307/2010535

Theme 3: Comparative environmental politics

There are large differences between countries when it comes to environmental policy. The literature on comparative environmental politics suggests various factors that contribute to this variation, ranging from the individual-attitudinal level to the level of political institutions. Review and critically discuss the proposed explanations in the literature.

- Aklin, Michaël, Matto Mildenberger; Prisoners of the Wrong Dilemma: Why Distributive Conflict, Not Collective Action, Characterizes the Politics of Climate Change. *Global Environmental Politics* 2020; 20 (4): 4–27. doi: https://doi.org/10.1162/glep_a_00578
- Anderson, Brilé, Tobias Böhmelt and Hugh Ward (2017). Public opinion and environmental policy output: a cross-national analysis of energy policies in Europe. *Environmental Research Letters* 2017; 12 (11). DOI 10.1088/1748-9326/aa8f80
- Bernauer, Thomas and Koubi, Vally, 2009. Effects of political institutions on air quality. *Ecological economics*, 68(5), pp.1355-1365.
- Povitkina, Marina, and Simon Matti, 'Quality of Government and Environmental Sustainability', in Andreas Bågenholm and others (eds), *The Oxford Handbook of the Quality of Government*, Oxford Handbooks (2021). Oxford: Oxford University Press, Pages 399-426
- Schulze, Kai; Policy Characteristics, Electoral Cycles, and the Partisan Politics of Climate Change. *Global Environmental Politics* 2021; 21 (2): 44–72. doi: https://doi.org/10.1162/glep_a_00593

Research Area: Political Behavior

Basic reading:

- Blais, André. 2009. Turnout in Elections. In *The Oxford Handbook of Political Behavior*, Dalton, Russell and Hans-Dieter Klingemann (eds.) New York: Oxford University Press, pp. 621-635.
- Brady, Henry E., Verba, Sidney and Lehman, Kay 1995. Beyond SES: A resource model of political participation. *American Political Science Review* 89:2 271-294
- Dalton, Russell J. & Klingemann, Hans-Dieter. 2011. Overview of Political Behavior: Political Behavior and Citizen Politics. In *The Oxford Handbook for Political Science*, Goodin, Robert E. (ed.). Oxford: Oxford University Press. Pages 321-344.
- Downs, A., 1957. *An economic theory of democracy*. Harper and Row. (Introduction and ch.3)
- Holmberg, S. 2009. Partisanship reconsidered. In *The Oxford handbook of political behaviour*, In *The Oxford Handbook of Political Behavior*, Dalton, Russell and Hans-Dieter Klingemann (eds.). Oxford, United Kingdom: Oxford University Press. Pages 557-570
- Inglehart, R.F. 2008. Changing values among western publics from 1970 to 2006. *West European Politics*, 31(1-2), pp.130-146.
- Lipset, Seymour Martin, and Stein Rokkan. 1990 (1967). Cleavage structures, party systems, and voter alignments. In *The West European Party System*, Mair, Peter (ed.). Oxford: Oxford University Press. P. 91-138.
- McAllister, I. 2007. The Personalization of Politics. In *The Oxford Handbook of Political Behavior*, Dalton, Russell and Hans-Dieter Klingemann (eds.). Oxford UK: Oxford University Press, pp. 571-588.
- Van Deth, Jan W. 2014. A conceptual map of political participation. *Acta Politica* 49(3): 349-367

Seminar 3

Theme 1. Political participation

In general a wide spread and equal political participation is regarded as an indicator of a “good democracy”. In most countries however, we observe ‘gaps’ in political participation related to social characteristics or personal resources. To what extent are various forms of political participation susceptible to related inequalities (e.g along class, age, education, income, gender etc)? Are there any contextual factors that might moderate the relationship between social characteristics or personal resources and various forms of political participation? In your answer focus on conceptual clarity (e.g definitions of various types of political participation), the theory behind the causal relationships and the relevant empirical evidence.

- Carreras, Miguel and Néstor Castañeda-Angarita 2019. Economic adversity and electoral participation of vulnerable socioeconomic groups. *Electoral Studies* 57: 110-120
- Oser, J., Hooghe, M. and Marien, S., 2013. Is online participation distinct from offline participation? A latent class analysis of participation types and their stratification. *Political research quarterly*, 66(1), pp.91-101.
- Kern, A., Marien, S. and Hooghe, M., 2015. Economic crisis and levels of political participation in Europe (2002-2010): The role of resources and grievances. *West European Politics*, 38(3), pp.465-490.
- Marien, S., Hooghe, M. and Quintelier, E., 2010. Inequalities in non-institutionalised forms of political participation: A multi-level analysis of 25 countries. *Political studies*, 58(1), pp.187-213.
- Borbáth, E., 2023. Differentiation in protest politics: participation by political insiders and outsiders. *Political Behavior*, pp.1-24.

Carreras, M., 2018. Why no gender gap in electoral participation? A civic duty explanation. *Electoral Studies*, 52, pp.36-45.

Theme 2. Short-term and long-term factors explaining party choice

This theme focuses on the degree of stability or change in models explaining voting behaviour. In doing so it particularly addresses the relative importance of some of the classic accounts of party choice (e.g the spatial vs valence approaches). A general assumption is that the impacts of short term factors (such as leader evaluations) have replaced long term explanatory factors for party choice (such as social class or party identification). Is that really so? In what ways could long term factors still have an impact on party choice?

Dassonneville, Ruth. 2016. Volatile voters, short-term choices? An analysis of the vote choice determinants of stable and volatile voters in Great Britain. *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties*, 26:3, 273-292

Evans, G., & Chzhen, K. 2016. Re-evaluating the valence model of political choice. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 4(1), pp. 199-220.

Sanders, D., Clarke, H. D., Stewart, M. C., & Whiteley, P. 2011. Downs, Stokes and the dynamics of electoral choice. *British Journal of Political Science*, 41(2), pp. 287-314.

Quinlan, S. and McAllister, I., 2022. Leader or party? Quantifying and exploring behavioral personalization 1996–2019. *Party Politics*, 28(1), pp.24-37.

Walczak, A., Van der Brug, W. and De Vries, C.E., 2012. Long-and short-term determinants of party preferences: Inter-generational differences in Western and East Central Europe. *Electoral studies*, 31(2), pp.273-284.

Dassonneville, R. and Lewis-Beck, M.S., 2019. A changing economic vote in Western Europe? Long-term vs. short-term forces. *European Political Science Review*, 11(1), pp.91-108.

Theme 3. New divides and their electoral consequences

Large scale socio-economic processes, stemming mainly from globalization, have eroded traditional alliances between parties and voters, increased electoral volatility and recently have shaken up entire party systems. What are the mechanisms through which these processes affect voting behaviour, which groups are more susceptible to these forces and what have been the resulting electoral outcomes in western democracies?

Dolezal, M., 2010. Exploring the stabilization of a political force: The social and attitudinal basis of green parties in the age of globalization. *West European Politics*, 33(3), pp.534-552.

Ford, R. and Jennings, W., 2020. The changing cleavage politics of Western Europe. *Annual review of political science*, 23, pp.295-314.

Inglehart, R. and Norris, P., 2017. Trump and the populist authoritarian parties: The silent revolution in reverse. *Perspectives on Politics*, 15(2), pp.443-454.

Kriesi, H., Grande, E., Lachat, R., Dolezal, M., Bornschier, S. and Frey, T., 2006. Globalization and the transformation of the national political space: Six European countries compared. *European Journal of Political Research*, 45(6), pp.921-956.

Xezonakis, G. and Hartmann, F., 2020. Economic downturns and the Greek referendum of 2015: Evidence using night-time light data. *European Union Politics*, 21(3), pp.361-382.

Rodrik, D., 2021. Why does globalization fuel populism? Economics, culture, and the rise of right-wing populism. *Annual Review of Economics*, 13, pp.133-170.

Marks, G., Attewell, D., Rovny, J. and Hooghe, L., 2020. Cleavage theory. In *The Palgrave handbook of EU crises* (pp. 173-193). Cham: Springer International Publishing.

Research Area: Public Administration and Administrative Reform

Basic reading:

- Besley, T., Burgess, R., Khan, A., & Xu, G. (2022). Bureaucracy and development. *Annual Review of Economics*, 14, 397-424.
- Peters, B. G. and J. Pierre (2003), "The Role of Public Administration in Governing", *Handbook of Public Administration*. Sid. 1-11. London: Sage.*
- Dahlström, Carl, and Victor Lapuente. Organizing leviathan: Politicians, bureaucrats, and the making of good government. Cambridge University Press, 2017. **Chapters 1 and 2. Pages 1-53**
- Miller G. 2000. Above politics: credible commitment and efficiency in the design of public agencies. *J. Public Admin. Res. Theory* 10(2):289–328
- Bersch, K., & Fukuyama, F. (2023). Defining Bureaucratic Autonomy. *Annual Review of Political Science*, 26.
- Drechsler, Wolfgang. (2020) Good Bureaucracy: Max Weber on the 100th anniversary of his death <https://medium.com/iipp-blog/good-bureaucracy-max-weber-on-the-100th-anniversary-of-his-death-c3dc6846d6be>
- Kulin, J., & Johansson Sevä, I. (2021). Quality of government and the relationship between environmental concern and pro-environmental behavior: a cross-national study. *Environmental Politics*, 30(5), 727-752.
- Oliveira, E., Abner, G., Lee, S., Suzuki, K., Hur, H., & Perry, J. L. (2024). What does the evidence tell us about merit principles and government performance?. *Public Administration*, 102(2), 668-690.
- Oliveros, V., & Schuster, C. (2018). Merit, tenure, and bureaucratic behavior: Evidence from a conjoint experiment in the Dominican Republic. *Comparative Political Studies*, 51(6), 759-792.
- Van Ryzin, G. G., & Riccucci, N. M. (2017). Representative bureaucracy: an experimental approach. *Experiments in Public Management Research: Challenges and Contributions*, 313-28.

Seminar 4

Theme 1. Public administration and sustainable economic development

A sustainable economic growth is essential for all societies. Which are the public administrations that contribute best to a sustained long-term economic growth? And to the protection of the environment? Is the Weberian ideal type of administration better because it ensures equality before law? Or is it a private sector-like administration? How public bureaucracy may help climate change adaptation?

- Biesbroek, R., Peters, B. G., & Tosun, J. (2018). Public bureaucracy and climate change adaptation. *Review of Policy Research*, 35(6), 776-791.
- Nistotskaya M, Cingolani L .2016. Bureaucratic structure, regulatory quality, and entrepreneurship in a comparative perspective: Cross-sectional and panel data evidence. *J. Public Adm. Res. Theory* 26(3):519–34
- Colonnelli, Emanuele, Mounu Prem, and Edoardo Teso. 2020. "Patronage and Selection in Public Sector Organizations." *American Economic Review*, 110 (10): 3071-99.
- Jiang J. 2018. Making bureaucracy work: Patronage networks, performance incentives, and economic development in China. *Am. J. Political Sci.* 62(4):982–99

Povitkina, M., & Bolkvadze, K. (2019). Fresh pipes with dirty water: How quality of government shapes the provision of public goods in democracies. *European Journal of Political Research*, 58(4), 1191-1212.

Theme 2. Public administration and corruption

Corruption, understood as the abuse of public office for private gain, is one of the most prevalent problems worldwide. Which are the best public administrations to control corruption? Are autonomous civil servants better than political appointees to engage in corrupt exchanges?

Charron, N., Dahlström, C., Fazekas, M., & Lapuente, V. (2017). Careers, Connections, and Corruption Risks: Investigating the impact of bureaucratic meritocracy on public procurement processes. *The Journal of Politics*, 79(1), 89-104.

Meyer-Sahling JH, Mikkelsen KS, Schuster C. 2018. Civil service management and corruption: What we know and what we don't. *Public Adm.* 96(2):276–85

Duvanova D. 2014. Economic regulations, red tape, and bureaucratic corruption in post-communist economies. *World Dev.* 59:298–312

Gans-Morse J, Borges M, Makarin A, Mannah-Blankson T, Nickow A, Zhang D. 2018. Reducing bureaucratic corruption: Interdisciplinary perspectives on what works. *World Dev.* 105:171-88

Theme 3. Public administration and public service quality

How services are provided is important for politicians, bureaucrats and the people. Which are the best public administrations to deliver high-quality public services?

Kim H, Jung H, Kim SY. 2021. Does politicization influence senior public officials' work attitudes? Different forms and effects of politicization in the civil service. *Public Manag. Rev.* 1–24

Lapuente, Victor, and Steven Van de Walle. "The effects of new public management on the quality of public services." *Governance* 33.3 (2020): 461-475.

Toral, G. (2022). How patronage delivers: Political appointments, bureaucratic accountability, and service delivery in Brazil. *American Journal of Political Science*.

Overman, S., & Van Thiel, S. (2016). Agencification and public sector performance: A systematic comparison in 20 countries. *Public Management Review*, 18(4), 611-635.

Pepinsky TB, Pierskalla JH, Sacks A. 2017. Bureaucracy and service delivery. *Annu. Rev. Political Sci* 20:249–

Research Area: International Politics

Basic Reading

Tilly, "War Making and State Making as Organized Crime," in Bringing the State Back in, Evans, Rueschemeyer and Skocpol
Stephen Walt (1998). "International Relations: One World, Many Theories." Foreign Policy (Spring): 29–46.
Anarchy is what States Make of it: The Social Construction of Power Politics, Alexander Wendt, International Organization, Vol. 46, No. 2 (Spring, 1992), pp. 391-425 (35 pages)

Optional, recommended:

Hobbes, Leviathan (the blue Cambridge edition - find it online as a free Google book), pp. 86-200.
Ronald H. Coase. The problem of social cost. Journal of Law and Economics, 3:1–44, 1960
Mancur Olson, Jr., The Logic of Collective Action, chapters 1 and 2, pp. 1-65.
Robert Axelrod. The Evolution of Cooperation. Basic Books, New York, 1984, pp. 1-54.
Robert Jervis (1978). "Cooperation Under the Security Dilemma." World Politics 30(2): 167–214.
(Read only the first half, from 167 to top of 183.)
Robert D. Putnam. Diplomacy and domestic politics: The logic of two-level games. International Organization, 42(3):427–460, 1988

Seminar 5

Theme 1: Privilege in International Relations

Some would argue that international relations theory privileges the rich and powerful, by structuring our view of the world in ways beneficial to their interests. Do you agree or disagree? Are there some theories which feature more of this bias? Are there some approaches that are better able to address the interests of the poor and the weak? You can pick a specific example, such as women's rights, ethnicity, East vs West. Justify your argument by referring to the readings and authors we have covered.

Vitalis, Robert. White World Order, Black Power Politics: The Birth of American International Relations. Cornell University Press, 2015.: Preface and Introduction, pp 1-27

Tate, Merze, and Doris M. Hull. (1964). "Effects of Nuclear Explosions on Pacific Islanders." Pacific Historical Review 33(4): 379–393.

Before the West, Ayse Zarakol, Chapter 4 (See Canvas)

Women and War, Elshtain, selected pages (see Canvas)

Theme 2: Dictatorship and War

Putin's invasion of Ukraine came as a surprise to the leadership in Kiev. Which theories of international relations would have predicted the invasion? Which theories of international relations would have predicted continuing peace? How does the fact that this war happened help us decide which theories

are more helpful when it comes to explaining the world we live in? Justify your argument by referring to the readings and authors we have covered.

Bruce Bueno de Mesquita and Alastair Smith. *The Dictator's Handbook: Why Bad Behavior Is Almost Always Good Politics*. Public Affairs, 2011.

Marten, Kimberly (2015) Putin's Choices: Explaining Russian Foreign Policy and Intervention in Ukraine, *The Washington Quarterly*, 38:2, 189-204

Mearsheimer, John (2014) 'Why the Ukraine is the West's Fault: The Liberal Illusions that Provoked Putin', *Foreign Affairs*, 77 Sept/Oct, 77-89

Theme 3. The Environment

Provide one successful example of a climate change problem being addressed at a state level, taken from a country you know. Now think about what it would take to implement such a solution at the global level. What are the specific impediments solving this problem would face on the global level? In your answer, engage theories of international relations by pointing out which theory seems to better explain or anticipate some of the problem issues you flag. Justify your argument by referring to the readings and authors we have covered.

Contestation and Resilience in the Liberal International Order: The Case of Climate Change, Alexander Thompson, *Global Studies Quarterly*, Volume 4, Issue 2, April 2024, ksae011, <https://doi.org/10.1093/isagsq/ksae011>

Gregg Easterbrook. "Global Warming: Who Loses—and Who Wins?" *The Atlantic*, 2007. (See Canvas)

"Implications of Russia's invasion of Ukraine for the governance of biodiversity conservation" Eduardo Gallo-Cajiao, et al. (23 authors), *Frontiers in Conservation Science*. 4:989019 (February 2023), 1-8.